

FEATHERED FIND

ARCHAEOPTERYX

The discovery of fossils of *Archaeopteryx* was one of the first finds to make paleontologists think that birds evolved from dinosaurs. Many even consider *Archaeopteryx* to be the first bird, capable of short bursts of flight. However, its fossils show that it also possessed similar traits to its theropod ancestors, including a bony tail and a jaw full of teeth. *Archaeopteryx* lived on a set of Late Jurassic islands in what is now Europe, and many well-preserved fossils have been found in a limestone quarry in Germany. The fossils are in such excellent condition because the creatures fell into prehistoric lagoons containing very salty water that preserved their delicate frames and soft tissues.

AT A GLANCE

- **YEAR OF DISCOVERY** 1875
- **PLACE** Germany
- **DISCOVERER** Jakob Niemeyer
- **LIVED** 150 MYA



FOSSILIZED FEATHER

Until 2018, this fossil feather was believed to belong to *Archaeopteryx*. However, recent research has shown that it belonged to a different feathered dinosaur, providing more evidence that dinosaurs didn't just have scaly skin.